Demo Build Co

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Loft & Extension Planning Checklist

Everything to sort out before you speak to any builder.

1. Planning route: which applies to you?

- [ ] Is it a house (not a flat or maisonette)?
- [ ] Is the property in a conservation area, or listed?
- [ ] Has an Article 4 direction removed permitted development rights?
- [ ] Have previous extensions used up part of the allowance?
- [ ] Decide: permitted development (+ Lawful Development Certificate) or planning application.

2. Drawings and documents

- [ ] Measured survey of the existing house
- [ ] Existing and proposed plans, elevations and sections
- [ ] Structural engineer's calculations (steels, beams, foundations)
- [ ] Building regulations application (full plans recommended)
- [ ] Build-over agreement if near a public sewer

3. Neighbours and party walls

- [ ] Which neighbours share a wall or boundary?
- [ ] Serve party wall notices: 2 months (party wall) / 1 month (boundary, excavation)
- [ ] Talk to neighbours early; it makes consent far more likely
- [ ] Budget for surveyors' fees if a neighbour dissents

4. Budget

- [ ] Get fixed written quotes for the same, clearly defined scope
- [ ] Check what's excluded (e.g. kitchen, flooring, decoration)
- [ ] Keep a contingency of 10–15%
- [ ] Fees: drawings, structural engineer, building control, party wall

5. Questions to ask any builder before you sign

- [ ] Can I see projects you've finished, and speak to the homeowners?
- [ ] Is the price fixed for the agreed scope? How are changes priced?
- [ ] Who runs my site day to day, and how do I contact them?
- [ ] How often will I get progress updates?
- [ ] What insurance do you hold? Can I see the certificates?

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- [ ] Who arranges building control sign-off and the completion certificate?
- [ ] What guarantee do you give, and is it in writing?
- [ ] What's the programme, week by week?
- [ ] How will you protect my home and keep the site tidy?
- [ ] Can we stay in the house during the work?
- [ ] What payment schedule do you use?
- [ ] Will you handle party wall notices and planning paperwork?

Ready? Book a free survey visit: we'll give you a fixed written quote.

General information only, not professional or legal advice. Rules apply to England and can change: always check with your own council for your property.